

DEATH'S HEAD

FIRST APPEARANCE The Transformers #113 (May 1987)

REAL NAME Death's Head

OCCUPATION Bounty hunter **BASE** New York City

HEIGHT Varies **WEIGHT** Varies **EYES** Varies **HAIR** Varies

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Superhumanly strong; able to detach limbs and substitute for weapons; controls limbs even when separated from body; jets in feet enable short-range flight.



Death's Head is a cyborg built by technomage Lupex as a shell for his mind. Lupex' plan was ruined by his wife, who activated the cyborg's consciousness. Following an encounter with the Time Lord known as the Doctor, he was dumped in the

year 8162 of Earth-5555. Since then, he has visited contemporary Earth-616 many times, jumping among times and dimensions. Death's Head II arose from the parts of the original and lived in Earth-8140. The latest version, Death's Head 3.0, sprang from Earth-6216. **AD, MF**

DE LA FONTAINE, CONTESSA

FIRST APPEARANCE Strange Tales #159 (August 1967)

REAL NAME Valentina Allegra de la Fontaine

OCCUPATION Former secret agent **BASE** Mobile

HEIGHT 5 ft 8 in **WEIGHT** 196 lbs

EYES Blue **HAIR** Black with white streak

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Superb strategist and hand-to-hand combatant; expert with most types of weapons.

During SHIELD training the Contessa caught the eye of NICK FURY by defeating him in hand-to-hand combat.

The two became lovers and teammates, working to help SHIELD put down threats from HYDRA and AIM. The Contessa later led SHIELD'S Femme Force. At one point, a Skrull posed as the Contessa, but Fury killed her. Years later, during the Secret Invasion, another SKRULL replaced the Contessa and attacked Dum Dum DUGAN. The real Contessa is now back in service. **DW, MF**



DEMOLITION-MAN

FIRST APPEARANCE The Thing Vol. 1 #28 (October, 1985)

REAL NAME Dennis Dunphy

OCCUPATION Adventurer **BASE** New York City

HEIGHT 6 ft 3 in **WEIGHT** 335 lbs **EYES** Blue **HAIR** None

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Enhanced strength and endurance; damage resistance; expert wrestler; trained in hand-to-hand combat by Captain America.

Given superhuman strength by the corrupt POWER BROKER, Dennis Dunphy became a member of the Unlimited Class Wrestling Federation. There, he befriended the THING, and later left the UCWF to become CAPTAIN AMERICA'S unofficial partner as the costumed hero D-Man. On a mission to infiltrate the FLAG-SMASHER'S Arctic stronghold, D-Man seemingly died in the explosion of an AVENGERS' Quinjet. However, D-Man survived among the Inuit for a time, before returning to New York City and becoming protector of the homeless in the subterranean Zerotown. **DW**



DEFENDERS

The Defenders are a loose affiliation of heroes. In fact, the core four Defenders are often at odds with one another, and only band together when there is no other option available. Initially, they allied themselves to face the menace posed by scientist-sorcerer Yandroth.

Thereafter, when met by circumstances in which they required assistance, the individual Defenders would often seek each other out. Other heroes, like HELLCAT and VALKYRIE, have wandered in and out of the team over the years. Under the Fifty State Initiative, a team composed of Blazing Skull, Colossus, DARKHAWK, and SHE-HULK guarded New Jersey. Once the Initiative disbanded it, it reformed with KRANG and HELLSTORM in place of Blazing Skull and Colossus. The Grandmaster recently gathered the original team to take on the RED HULK'S Offenders. **TB, MF**



Despite functioning as a "non-team", the Defenders have formed tight bonds.

FACTFILE

KEY MEMBERS

DOCTOR STRANGE

Command of the mystic arts.

NAMOR, THE SUB-MARINER

Superhuman strength and durability; ability to fly; ability to breathe air and also survive beneath the ocean waves.

HULK

Rampaging monster of almost unlimited strength.

SILVER SURFER

Possesses the Power Cosmic, one of the fundamental forces of the universe.

BASE

The Defenders team usually operates out of Doctor Strange's sanctum in Greenwich Village, New York City.

FIRST APPEARANCE

Marvel Feature #1 (December 1971)

THE DEFENDERS

1 Namor, the Sub-Mariner 2 The Hulk
3 The Silver Surfer 4 Doctor Strange